

Chapter 41-1

There was a direct elevator to the top floor of the mall, which was in a different direction from where Qi Tai Tai¹ was shopping.

Perhaps their intense gazes were too burning, as Qi Tai Tai suddenly turned to look in their direction. But in that instant, Liang Shi immediately turned her back and lowered her head.

It was a fear and panic carved deep into her bones.

Even her mind kept replaying that woman's gaze and smile.

After a while, Xu Qingzhu said quietly, "Let's go."

Liang Shi let out a soft breath, closed her eyes to adjust her state, then stood up and tightly held Ling Dang's hand as they walked toward the elevator.

Ling Dang was also exceptionally well-behaved.

Her little palm gently traced across Liang Shi's palm, "Auntie, your palm is so sweaty."

"It's nothing." Liang Shi's emotions were somewhat low, but she didn't want to show it in front of the child. She forced a smile, "It's because it's too hot."

"Aunt's hand is cool, let her hold yours." Ling Dang used her own hand as a medium, directly pulling Xu Qingzhu's hand over, and then their palms touched, skin against skin.

Ling Dang wasn't wrong.

Xu Qingzhu's palm was very cool, different from her own warm and sweaty palm.

Ling Dang then ran to her other side and took hold of her other hand, "Auntie, Aunt and I will both protect you."

Liang Shi was both amused and touched by her, but her heart felt warm.

She felt a bit embarrassed to hold Xu Qingzhu's hand, but was afraid Ling Dang would make a fuss, so she kept her hand suspended, only allowing a finger to occasionally brush against Xu Qingzhu's skin.

Unexpectedly, Xu Qingzhu suddenly gripped her hand tightly.

Liang Shi looked over in confusion.

Xu Qingzhu smiled calmly, "Consider it helping me warm my hands."

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Xu Qingzhu was considerate of Liang Shi's feelings and didn't ask a single question about Qi Tai Tai and Qi Jiao while they were outside.

Since Ling Dang had etiquette classes on Saturday, they sent her back to the old residence after lunch and made her promise to keep secret about encountering Qi Nai Nai² and Aunt Qi Jiao at the mall.

Ling Dang raised her hand and zipped her mouth shut, "Okay."

Because she found the old residence too gloomy, Liang Shi only escorted Ling Dang inside before making an excuse about having something to do and leaving.

Qiu Zimin, hearing the news of her return, hurriedly ran out but only caught sight of the car's tail.

However, Liang Shi saw her and Sun Meirou through the rearview mirror, not knowing what they were discussing.

It probably wasn't anything pleasant, considering Qiu Zimin was frowning the entire time.

After returning home, Liang Shi was prepared to tell Xu Qingzhu about Qi Tai Tai.

But unexpectedly, Xu Qingzhu didn't mention it at all and just went to the study to read.

Since Liang Shi herself hadn't figured things out either, she returned to her room to rest.

Ever since encountering Qi Tai Tai, a string in her heart seemed to be pulled taut.

That string made her entire emotional state drop, leaving her feeling dejected.

She never particularly liked being in such a state, so she would usually adjust through exercise or sleep.

Haizhou City's autumn was often rainy. Once it started, it would continue drizzling endlessly.

The morning sky that had been clear soon became overcast with dark clouds rapidly moving across the sky. The sky immediately darkened, and before long, the gentle patter of autumn rain began falling on earth.

It was just like Liang Shi's current mood.

Her entire body sank into the soft bed, watching the raindrops on the glass connect and interweave, the green branches swaying back and forth in the wind.

Such an environment was like a huge, gentle cocoon, with raindrops falling in orderly rhythm, joining with the wind to play a symphony.

It was a rhythm that could easily lull one to sleep.

Footnotes: ¹ Qi Tai Tai - "Tai Tai" is an honorific title for a married woman, similar to "Mrs." but with implications of wealth and status ² Qi Nai Nai - "Nai Nai" means grandmother, a term of address for elderly women